

At 40, Edin Dzeko continues to defy age and odds. He was the team's highest scorer in the European qualifiers, netting six times in nine games.

Bosnia has also benefited from the World Cup's expansion to 48 teams and made it to the quadrennial showpiece after 12 years. It suffered defeats against Argentina and Nigeria in 2014, but the lack of a proper heavyweight this time could pave the way for a first-ever knockout-stage appearance.

A maiden knockout qualification is also the objective for Qatar, whose World Cup cycle has been something of a mixed bag. After retaining the AFC Asian Cup in 2023, Qatar was forced to take the longer route to qualification.

Defeats to Uzbekistan, the UAE and Iran meant it had to play the fourth round of AFC qualifiers in Asia to advance. Julen Lopetegui's appointment helped it steady the ship just in time, but the side's preparations before the World Cup were disrupted by the Iran-US war.

Like Canada under Marsch, Qatar will be keen on picking up a maiden World Cup win under its new Spanish manager, and in Group B, it has the best chance to achieve it.



Edin Dzeko (Bosnia and Herzegovina)

Dzeko scored for Bosnia and Herzegovina 12 years ago when it beat Iran 3-1 for its first World Cup win. He returns to football's showpiece event as his country's highest goalscorer (73) and will be hungry to add to that tally.



Akram Afif (Qatar)

Afif scored a hat-trick in the Asian Cup final in 2023 when Qatar beat Jordan 3-1. He had also impressed in the side's first continental triumph in 2019. However, after the dismal outing in its maiden World Cup appearance, Afif will be eager to set the record straight.

SQUADS

Switzerland

Goalkeepers: Gregor Kobel, Marvin Keller, Yvon Mvogo

Defenders: Manuel Akanji, Aurele Amenda, Eray Comert, Nico Elvedi, Luca Jaquez, Miro Muheim, Ricardo Rodriguez, Silvan Widmer

Midfielders: Michel Aebischer, Christian Fassnacht, Remo Freuler, Cedric Itten, Ardon Jashari, Fabian Rieder, Djibril Sow, Granit Xhaka, Denis Zakaria

Forwards: Zeki Amdouni, Breel Embolo, Johan Manzambi, Dan Ndoye, Noah Okafor, Ruben Vargas

Canada

Goalkeepers: Maxime Crepeau, Owen Goodman, Dayne St. Clair

Defenders: Moïse Bombito, Derek Cornelius, Alphonso Davies, Luc de Fougerolles, Alistair Johnston, Alfie Jones, Richie Laryea, Niko Sigur, Joel Waterman

Midfielders: Ali Ahmed, Tajon Buchanan, Mathieu Choiniere, Stephen Eustáquio, Ismael Kone, Liam Millar, Jonathan Osorio, Nathan Saliba, Jacob Shaffelburg

Forwards: Jonathan David, Promise David, Cyle Larin, Tani Oluwaseyi

Bosnia and Herzegovina

Goalkeepers: Nikola Vasilj, Martin Zlomislic, Osman Hadzikic

Defenders: Sead Kolasinac, Amar Dedic, Nihad Mujakic, Nikola Katic, Tarik Muharemovic, Stjepan Radeljic, Dennis Hadzikadunic, Nidal Celik

Midfielders: Amir Hadziahmetovic, Ivan Sunjic, Ivan Basic, Dzenis Burnic, Ermin Mahmic, Benjamin Tahirovic, Amar Memic, Armin Gigovic, Kerim Alajbegovic, Esmir Bajraktarevic

Forwards: Ermedin Demirovic, Jovo Lukic, Samed Bazdar, Haris Tabakovic, Edin Dzeko

Qatar

Goalkeepers: Salah Zakaria, Mahmoud Abunada, Meshaal Barsham

Defenders: Hashmi Hussein, Ayoub Alawi, Boualem Khoukhi, Pedro Miguel, Issa Laaye, Lucas Mendes, Sultan Al-Brake, Homam Al-Amin

Midfielders: Mohammed Al-Manai, Jassem Jaber, Karim Boudiaf, Ahmed Fathi, Abdulaziz Hatem, Assim Madibo

Forwards: Tahseen Mohammed, Edmilson Junior, Almoez Ali, Akram Afif, Mohammed Muntari, Youssef Abdulrazzaq, Ahmed Alaa, Hassan Al-Haydos, Ahmed Al-Janahi